

LESSON NOTE: WORDS OF THREE SYLLABLES STRESSED ON THE FIRST SYLLABLE

Subject: English Language

Topic: Stress

Sub-topic: Words of Three Syllables Stressed on the First Syllable

Duration: 40 minutes

INTRODUCTION

In English Language, stress refers to the extra force or emphasis placed on a syllable when a word is pronounced. In words with more than one syllable, one syllable is pronounced louder, longer, or more clearly than the others. This lesson focuses on three-syllable words that are stressed on the first syllable.

DEFINITION OF STRESS

Stress is the emphasis placed on a particular syllable in a word during pronunciation.

THREE-SYLLABLE WORDS

A three-syllable word is a word that can be broken into three distinct sound units (syllables).

Example:

BEAU-ti-ful (3 syllables)

WORDS OF THREE SYLLABLES STRESSED ON THE FIRST SYLLABLE

In these words, the first syllable is pronounced more strongly than the other two.

The stressed syllable is often shown in capital letters.

EXAMPLES

Word

Syllable Division

Stressed Syllable

Beautiful

BEAU-ti-ful

First

Family

FA-mi-ly

First

Cinema

Cl-ne-ma

First

Saturday

SA-tur-day

First

Possible

PO-ssi-ble

First

Customer

CUS-to-mer

First

Yesterday

YES-ter-day

First

Vegetable

VEG-e-ta-ble

First

Animal

A-ni-mal

First

President

PRE-si-dent

First

RULES GOVERNING THREE-SYLLABLE WORDS STRESSED ON THE FIRST SYLLABLE

Most nouns and adjectives of three syllables are stressed on the first syllable.

VEG-e-ta-ble

BEAU-ti-ful

Words ending in -er, -or, -ly, -ence, -ance often carry stress on the first syllable.

CUS-to-mer

FA-mi-ly

Many common everyday words have first-syllable stress.

IMPORTANCE OF CORRECT STRESS

It helps in clear pronunciation

It improves listening and speaking skills

It prevents misunderstanding in communication

It helps students perform better in WAEC oral English

CLASS ACTIVITY

Pronounce the following words correctly and identify the stressed syllable:

Saturday

Cinema

Animal

Clap once on the stressed syllable while pronouncing each word.

EVALUATION

Define stress.

Mention three words of three syllables stressed on the first syllable.

Underline the stressed syllable in this word: vegetable.

ASSIGNMENT

Write five words of three syllables and indicate the syllable that is stressed.